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The Beginning

(Genesis 1:1-2; Hebrews 11:1-3)

¹In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ²He was with God in the beginning. ³Through Him all things were made, and without Him nothing was made that has been made. ⁴In Him was life, and that life was the light of men. ⁵The Light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome¹ it.

The Witness of John

⁶There came a man who was sent from God. His name was John. ⁷He came as a witness to testify about the Light, so that through him everyone might believe. ⁸He himself was not the Light, but he came to testify about the Light. ⁹The true Light, who gives light to everyone, was coming into the world. ¹⁰He was in the world, and though the world was made through Him, the world did not recognize Him. ¹¹He came to His own, and His own did not receive Him. ¹²But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God— ¹³children born not of blood, nor of the desire or will of man, but born of God.

The Word Became Flesh

(Psalms 84:1-12)

¹⁴The Word became flesh and

1. 1:5 Or comprehended

made His dwelling among us.² We have seen His glory, the glory of the one and only Son³ from the Father, full of grace and truth. ¹⁵John testified concerning Him. He cried out, saying, "This is He of whom I said, 'He who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.'" ¹⁶From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. ¹⁷For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. ¹⁸No one has ever seen God, but the one and only Son, who is Himself God and⁴ is at the Father's side,⁵ has made Him known.

The Mission of John the Baptist

(Isaiah 40:1-5; Matthew 3:1-12; Mark 1:1-8; Luke 3:1-20)

¹⁹And this was John's testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him, "Who are you?" ²⁰He did not refuse to confess, but openly declared, "I am not the Christ." ²¹"Then who are you?" they inquired. "Are you Elijah?"⁶ He said, "I am not." "Are you the Prophet?" He answered, "No." ²²So they said to him, "Who are you? We need an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?" ²³John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet:

"I am a voice of one calling in the wilderness,

2. 1:14 Or and tabernacled among us

3. 1:14 Or the Only Begotten or the Unique One

4. 1:18 Or but the only begotten God, who; BYZ and TR but the only begotten Son, who

5. 1:18 Greek in the Father's bosom

6. 1:21 Mal. 4:5; Matt. 11:14

7. 1:23 Isaiah 40:3 (see also LXX)

8. 1:26 Or in; also in verse 31 and twice in 33

'Make straight the way for the Lord.'"⁷

²⁴Then the Pharisees who had been sent ²⁵asked him, "Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?" ²⁶"I baptize with⁸ water," John replied, "but among you stands One you do not know. ²⁷He is the One who comes after me, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie." ²⁸All this happened at Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

Jesus the Lamb of God

(Matthew 3:13-17; Mark 1:9-11; Luke 3:21-22)

²⁹The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" ³⁰This is He of whom I said, 'A man who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.' ³¹I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that He might be revealed to Israel." ³²Then John testified, "I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove and resting on Him. ³³I myself did not know Him, but the One who sent me to baptize with water told me, 'The man on whom you see the Spirit descend and rest is He who will baptize with the Holy Spirit.' ³⁴I have seen and testified

that this is the Son of God.⁹

The First Disciples

(Matthew 4:18-22; Mark 1:16-20; Luke 5:1-11)

³⁵The next day John was there again with two of his disciples.

³⁶When he saw Jesus walking by,

he said, "Look, the Lamb of God!"

³⁷And when the two disciples heard him say this, they followed Jesus.

³⁸Jesus turned and saw them following. "What do you want?" He

asked. They said to Him, "Rabbi" (which means Teacher), "where are

You staying?" ³⁹"Come and see,"

He replied. So they went and saw where He was staying, and spent

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that day with Him. It was about the
tenth hour.

